

TEXT OF REMARKS BY
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(K'ayayen Sarkin Musulmi, Wakilin Maganin Zazzau, Iyan Piriga)
CHAIRMAN, BOARD OF TRUSTEES (BoT), AHMADU BELLO UNIVERSITY
PHARMACY ALUMNI ASSOCIATION (ABUPAA)
PRESENTED ON THE OCCASION OF THE INAUGURATION OF THE INTERIM
NATIONAL EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE (NEC) OF ABUPAA
ON MONDAY, 23rd MARCH, 2026, AT THE BOARDROOM OF THE FACULTY OF
PHARMACEUTICAL SCIENCES, ABU MAIN CAMPUS, SAMARU, ZARIA

Protocol.

It is my pleasure to welcome members of the Board of Trustees (BoT) of the Ahmadu Bello University Pharmacy Alumni Association (ABUPAA), the Dean and other staff members of the Faculty of Pharmaceutical Sciences, ABU Zaria, graduates of the Faculty of Pharmaceutical Sciences, ABU Zaria, invited guests, and students.

Today marks an important occasion as we are gathered here to witness the inauguration of the Interim National Executive Committee (NEC) of the Ahmadu Bello University Pharmacy Alumni Association (ABUPAA).

It is important, however, that we go down memory lane as far back as thirty-two (32) years to 1994, when ABUPAA was established.

At that time, there were no structures as organs of the Ahmadu Bello University Alumni Association. ABUPAA, arising from an awakened consciousness by pharmacists who graduated from the School of Pharmacy, Zaria (established in 1933), the Department of Pharmacy and Pharmacology, Faculty of Science, ABU Zaria, and the present Faculty of Pharmaceutical Sciences, ABU Zaria, thus became the first faculty-based chapter within the larger Ahmadu Bello University

Alumni Association. This preceded the latter's constitution, which was drafted in 2014 (as amended), twenty (20) years after the establishment of ABUPAA.

What started in the Project Implementation Unit (PIU) of the African Development Bank (AfDB) / African Development Fund (AfDF)-Assisted Kaduna Health Rehabilitation Project (KHRP) at the Kaduna State Ministry of Health (MoH) headquarters on Independence Way, Kaduna, extended to Jos during the 1995 Annual National Conference of the Pharmaceutical Society of Nigeria (PSN), where pharmacy graduates of the aforementioned institutions in Zaria were informed of the establishment of ABUPAA.

In 1996, Ilorin, the capital of Kwara State, hosted the PSN Annual Conference, where more pharmacists were informed of the establishment of ABUPAA.

In March 1997, ABUPAA was inaugurated at the Pa Ishaku Lecture Theatre, Faculty of Pharmaceutical Sciences, ABU Zaria, by the then Sole Administrator, Major General Mamman Tsoho Kontagora (Rtd) of blessed memory. That was how ABUPAA was formally introduced to ABU, Zaria.

Other notable personalities who witnessed the event included Mallam Hamza R. Zayyad (Wazirin Katsina), Professor Gabriel E. Osuide, the foundation Dean of the Faculty of Pharmaceutical Sciences, ABU Zaria, who was at the time the Director-General and CEO of the National Agency for Food and Drug Administration and Control (NAFDAC), all principal officers of the University, many past Deans, alumni of the Faculty, as well as staff and students of the University.

The Interim National Executive Committee (NEC) of ABUPAA, under my chairmanship, was unanimously elected as the substantive Executive Committee at the first Annual General Meeting (AGM) held after the inauguration.

Fast forward to March 2008, when the second AGM and Homecoming of ABUPAA members took place at the same Pa Ishaku Lecture Theatre, Faculty of Pharmaceutical Sciences, ABU Zaria.

On that occasion, His Excellency, Pharm. Danbaba Danfulani Suntai, the Governor of Taraba State and a distinguished graduate of the Faculty of Pharmaceutical Sciences, ABU Zaria, was in attendance. Professor Osuide, past Deans of the Faculty, and other dignitaries were also present. At the second AGM, members of the National Executive Committee were all returned unopposed.

On 15th October 2011, the Gabriel Osuide Lecture Theatres (1 & 2), built at a cost of ₦300,000,000.00 (Three Hundred Million Naira) by the Taraba State Government under the auspices of ABUPAA and donated to the Faculty of Pharmaceutical Sciences, ABU Zaria, were commissioned. Once again, His Excellency Governor Danbaba Danfulani Suntai, Professor Osuide, all past Deans of the Faculty, and ABUPAA members from across the country attended.

At the time, the GOLT (1 & 2) represented the largest intervention in the University by any organ of the Alumni Association.

Earlier, in 2010, the Board of Trustees (BoT) of ABUPAA was registered by the Corporate Affairs Commission (CAC), and members of the NEC, along with a few others, became BoT members.

Shortly after the commissioning of the GOLT (1&2), the BoT appointed Professor Isa Marte Hussaini as Chairman of the Interim Committee of ABUPAA.

From around 2015, Professor Hussaini, who resides in Maiduguri, his home state, was given a political appointment by the Borno State Government, which made it difficult for him to run ABUPAA. In 2019, he assumed even greater responsibilities, having been appointed Chief of Staff, Government House, Maiduguri.

Unfortunately, in November 2022, he fell ill and is yet to recover. May Allah accelerate his healing process, Ameen. This is where we are at the moment.

As there cannot be a vacuum over all these years, it was decided that Pharm. Aliyu Jibrin should step in as Chairman of the Interim NEC of ABUPAA.

This is the current position.

Below is a tabulation of the leadership of ABUPAA from inception to date:

EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE LEADERSHIP AT ABUPAA (1994 - DATE)

S/ NO	NAME	CAPACITY	PERIOD
1	Pharm. A.T Mora	Interim Chairman/Foundation Member	1994 – 1997 (3yrs)
2	Pharm. A.T Mora	Chairman (Confirmed at Congress)	1997 – 2008 (11 yrs)
3	Pharm. A.T Mora	Chairman (Re-elected at Congress)	2008 – 2011 (3yrs)
4	Prof. Isa Marte Hussaini	Interim Chairman (Appt. by BoT)	2011 – 2026 (15yrs (Most part inactive due to indisposition of Chairman)
5	Pharm. Aliyu Jibrin	Interim Chairman (Appt by BoT)	2026 – date.

The members of the Interim National Executive Committee (NEC) of ABUPAA are as follows:

- Pharm. Aliyu Jibrin – Chairman
- Prof. Nuhu Muhammad Danjuma – Vice Chairman
- Dr. Abdurrahman Adamu – Secretary
- Pharm. (Mrs) Bosede Garba – Public Relations Officer

These individuals are hereby, today, Monday, 23rd March, 2026, inaugurated as members of the Interim National Executive Committee of ABUPAA.

This appointment is in recognition of your dedication to the cause of pharmacy education and practice, especially within the Faculty of Pharmaceutical Sciences, ABU Zaria, and among graduates of the Faculty who are diligently practicing the profession of pharmacy ethically and as proud alumni.

Kindly accept the congratulations of the Board, as well as the Deanery of the Faculty of Pharmaceutical Sciences, ABU Zaria.

Finally, I recommend that you familiarize yourselves with the file of activities of ABUPAA, especially the book titled:

“THE CONTRIBUTIONS OF STUDENTS AND ALUMNI ASSOCIATIONS TOWARDS PROMOTING PHARMACY EDUCATION AND PRACTICE IN NIGERIA (MORA, 2014)”, which was presented to the public in May 2014 at Arewa House, Kaduna.

The book contains an entire section where the chronological development of ABUPAA from 1994 to 2014—a period of twenty (20) years—is well articulated, including meetings, donations, assistance to the Faculty, interventions, challenges, and many documented events.

Finally, I wish you all a successful tenure, while praying that Almighty God guides and protects you at all times in the discharge of your responsibilities as members of the National Executive Committee of ABUPAA.

Thank you very much for listening and for your rapt attention.